

What changed from SCS-C02, and what the console will not match

The final teaching module. Every dated finding from this course, assembled.

The exam moved. AWS moved further.
Neither moved everything – and knowing
which is which is the point of this module.

The domain mapping, from AWS's own table

SCS - C02	SCS - C03
D1 Threat Detection and Incident Response 14%	D1 Detection 16%
D2 Security Logging and Monitoring 18%	D2 Incident Response 14%
D3 Infrastructure Security 20%	D3 Infrastructure Security 18%
D4 Identity and Access Management 16%	D4 Identity and Access Management 20%
D5 Data Protection 18%	D5 Data Protection 18%
D6 Management and Security Governance 14%	D6 Security Foundations and Governance 14%

ON THE EXAM

Domains 1 and 2 were not reweighted so much as rebuilt: logging and monitoring split across the new Detection and Incident Response domains.

What the reweighting means for your time

- ◆ **IAM is the biggest gainer**, 16% to 20%. It is now the heaviest single domain.
- ◆ Roughly two more scored questions. Modules 19 to 25, and module 19 most of all.
- ◆ **Detection rose to 16%**, incident response fell to 14%, and old task 1.1 was split across **four** new tasks.
- ◆ **Infrastructure fell 20% to 18%** and is still third-largest. Not permission to skip it.
- ◆ Data protection is unchanged at 18% – and its **content** changed substantially.

ON THE EXAM

A percentage point is roughly half a scored question. The content changes matter more.

Content added in SCS-C03

- ◆ 2.2.3 Validate findings for scope and impact. 3.1.4 Edge and third-party integrations, OCSF, third-party WAF rules.
- ◆ 3.2.7 Guardrails for generative AI, applying the OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications.
- ◆ 5.1.3 Inter-node encryption for EMR, EKS, SageMaker AI, and Nitro encryption.
- ◆ 5.3.3 Imported vs AWS-generated key material. 5.3.4 Masking and anonymisation. 5.3.5 Keys across Regions.
- ◆ Every one had near-zero coverage in a C02-era question bank. That absence is the signal.

ON THE EXAM

Six added skills, five of them in Domains 3 and 5 – whose weights barely moved.

Content removed in SCS-C03

- ◆ **TLS concepts** from 5.1. The mechanisms remain; handshake internals do not.
- ◆ **Components of a policy** from 4.2. You still cannot read a policy without them.
- ◆ **Host-based security and hardening** from 3.2. Image Builder, Patch Manager and IMDS remain.
- ◆ **VPC Reachability Analyzer** from 3.4 – while Network Access Analyzer stayed.
- ◆ **Removed as a stated skill is not removed from the exam.**

ON THE EXAM

This course taught all four anyway, and said so each time.

Services whose status changed

SERVICE	WHAT HAPPENED	WHEN
AWS Incident Manager	Closed to new customers; no new features	7 Nov 2025
Amazon CodeGuru Security	Discontinued; console and docs removed	20 Nov 2025
Amazon CodeGuru Reviewer	No new repository associations	7 Nov 2025
AWS Audit Manager	Maintenance mode; closed to new accounts	30 Apr 2026
AWS Security Hub	Split into Security Hub CSPM and Security Hub	Dec 2025
Shield Advanced auto L7 mitigation	Retiring; WAF Anti-DDoS rule group replaces it	1 Jan 2027

ON THE EXAM

Three of these changed status before or just after C03 went live on 2 December 2025 – and the exam guide still names some of them.

Defaults and capabilities that moved

WHAT	CHANGE	WHEN
Root user MFA	Enforced across all account types	17 Jun 2025
S3 SSE-C	Disabled by default on new buckets	6 Apr 2026
Declarative policies	New Organizations policy type	Nov 2024
Centralised root access	Remove member root credentials; sts:AssumeRoot	Nov 2024
Resource control policies	New policy type; Cognito and Logs added	Nov 2024 / Jan 2026
VPC encryption controls	Enforce in-transit encryption; Flow Logs field	Nov 2025
KMS rotation period	Configurable 90 to 2,560 days	–

ON THE EXAM

The SSE-C change has a ransomware story behind it, and the root MFA change turns a best practice into a requirement.

Where the console will not match older material

- ◆ **Security Hub** – the console distinguishes **Security Hub CSPM**. Older material means CSPM.
- ◆ **Cognito** – 'advanced security features' is now **threat protection**, in the **Plus** plan. Managed Login replaced the hosted UI.
- ◆ **Control Tower** – 'guardrails' are **controls**, and preventive ones may be declarative policies.
- ◆ **IAM Identity Center** was AWS SSO. **Q Developer** absorbed CodeGuru's code review.
- ◆ **Access Analyzer** now has three analyzer types. Older material is incomplete, not wrong.

ON THE EXAM

A screenshot that does not match your console is the cheapest signal that material is stale.

How to date material yourself

- ◆ **Check whether it mentions RCPs, declarative policies or centralised root access.** All three arrived November 2024. Absence dates it.
- ◆ **Check what it calls things.** AWS SSO, guardrails, advanced security features, CodeGuru – each is a timestamp.
- ◆ **Check whether root MFA is described as a recommendation.** If so, it predates June 2025.
- ◆ **Check whether Security Hub is qualified as CSPM.** If not, it predates December 2025.
- ◆ And when a service name sounds right but nothing in the console matches, **search AWS's own What's New and documentation history** before assuming you are wrong.

ON THE EXAM

This course logged every dated finding with a date and a source, so you can re-check any of them yourself rather than trusting me.

A candidate has three weeks and a complete set of SCS-C02 study notes. They ask where to concentrate the additional effort, given the domain reweighting.

Their notes are strong on logging, networking and encryption, and thinner on policy evaluation and federation.

What is the best allocation?

- ☐ A Identity and access management, which rose from 16% to 20% and is now the heaviest domain
- ☐ B Infrastructure security, which is still the largest at 20%
- ☐ C Data protection, since its weighting is unchanged and therefore predictable
- ☐ D Incident response, which rose from 14% to 18%

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best allocation?

- A

 IAM, 16% to 20%, now the heaviest
Correct. The largest single reweighting, now the heaviest domain, and the candidate's stated weakness. All three point the same way.
- B

 Infrastructure security, still largest at 20%
It fell to 18% in C03 and is no longer the largest. The stated figure is the C02 one, which is exactly the trap a C02-era set of notes creates.
- C

 Data protection, unchanged and predictable
The weighting is unchanged and the content is not – five of the six added skills sit in Domains 3 and 5. Unchanged weight hides substantial new content.
- D

 Incident response, 14% to 18%
Backwards. Incident response fell to 14%; it was Security Logging and Monitoring that sat at 18% under a different name.

THE SIGNAL

Three of the four options quote a C02 figure as though it were current. That is the shape of the whole module.

A team's incident response runbook, written against SCS-C02 guidance, specifies AWS Incident Manager for declaring and coordinating security incidents. A new joiner cannot find the service available to enable.

The team asks what the current AWS-recommended equivalent is, and what the SCS-C03 exam guide names.

What should they be told?

- ☐ A Incident Manager was renamed AWS Security Incident Response; migrate to it
- ☐ B Incident Manager is Region-limited; enable it in us-east-1
- ☐ C It closed to new customers in November 2025; the C03 guide names Systems Manager OpsCenter
- ☐ D It requires Enterprise Support, which the team does not have

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they be told?

- A

 Renamed AWS Security Incident Response
The strongest distractor. AWS Security Incident Response is a real, separate service – and it is not in the C03 in-scope list, and Incident Manager was not renamed to it.
- B

 Region-limited; use us-east-1
The shape of a plausible availability answer. The restriction is on new customers, not on Regions.
- C

 Closed to new customers Nov 2025; C03 names OpsCenter
Correct. Skill 2.1.1 names OpsCenter and never mentions Incident Manager – so teaching Incident Manager is teaching a distractor.
- D

 Needs Enterprise Support
Support plans gate the Shield Response Team, not service availability. A plausible-sounding gate applied to the wrong thing.

THE SIGNAL

The exam guide went live 2 December 2025, three weeks after Incident Manager closed – and it names OpsCenter, not Incident Manager.

An engineer follows a well-regarded 2024 study guide that instructs them to enable Cognito 'advanced security features' to detect compromised credentials. The console has no such setting.

They also cannot find the hosted UI configuration the guide describes.

What is the current position?

- ☐ A The features were withdrawn; use GuardDuty for credential detection instead
- ☐ B They were renamed threat protection and moved into the Plus feature plan; Managed Login replaced the hosted UI
- ☐ C Advanced security features now require an external SAML identity provider
- ☐ D They moved into AWS WAF as the Fraud Control rule group

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the current position?

- A

 Withdrawn; use GuardDuty
The capability exists under a new name. GuardDuty does not inspect Cognito sign-ins against breach data - a different service answering a different question.
- B

 Renamed threat protection, in the Plus tier; Managed Login replaced the hosted UI
Correct. Both changes landed in the November 2024 Cognito renewal, which is why a 2024 guide can be right about the capability and wrong about every name.
- C

 Requires an external SAML IdP
The reverse of the truth - threat protection applies to local users, and an external IdP owns the security posture of federated ones.
- D

 Moved into WAF Fraud Control
WAF Fraud Control is real and separate, covering account takeover and creation fraud at the edge. Cognito's threat protection did not move there.

THE SIGNAL

Two renames in one release. The capability the guide describes is real, present, and findable under none of the words it uses.

After reviewing the changes, a candidate begins doubting their SCS-C02 foundation entirely. They ask which of four things they learned two years ago are still true.

The four are: SCPs do not restrict the management account; a KMS key policy is required for any access to that key; an explicit Deny always wins; and CloudTrail data events are off by default.

How many of the four are still true?

- ☐ A One – only the explicit Deny rule survives unchanged
- ☐ B Two – the SCP and Deny rules; the KMS and CloudTrail statements changed
- ☐ C Three – CloudTrail data events are now enabled by default
- ☐ D All four remain true and unchanged

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How many of the four are still true?

- A

 One
Over-corrects. Doubting everything after learning that some things changed is its own error, and it is the one this scenario exists to catch.
- B

 Two
Both the KMS and CloudTrail statements are still accurate. The key policy is still the root of trust, and data events still cost extra and are still off.
- C

 Three – data events now default on
Data events are still off by default, and still charged separately. That default has not moved, and module 1 built a scenario on it.
- D

 All four
Correct. Every one remains true. The foundation held – what changed were specific services, defaults and names, not the evaluation model.

THE SIGNAL

The inversion. After a module full of changes, the exam-relevant skill is knowing what did not change.

Six things to carry forward

- ◆ **IAM went 16% to 20%**, now the heaviest. Domains 1 and 2 were rebuilt.
- ◆ **Six skills added** – GenAI, masking, inter-node encryption, key provenance, multi-Region keys, validating findings.
- ◆ **Four removals are of stated skills**, not of the material.
- ◆ **Four services changed status** around the C03 launch.
- ◆ **Two defaults changed** – root MFA enforced, SSE-C disabled on new buckets.
- ◆ **The fundamentals did not move.**

ON THE EXAM

That closes the teaching. Next: four practice exams, 80 questions, weighted to the real distribution.